added to more speculation. After Indira Gandhi's assassination, the Rajiv Gandhi government continued to call for an equal and non-discriminatory agreement between nuclear and non-nuclear weapon countries. According to the R&AW reports, India wanted the destruction of all nuclear arsenals across the globe before complete disarmament agreements were signed. It took the lead in the United Nations in January 1987 by suggesting that all countries must suspend nuclear testing with immediate effect. The Indian view was simple: disarmament is necessary not just for the maintenance of global peace but for the very survival of mankind. India was elected President of the United Nations Disarmament Committee meeting in August 1987. However, the USA did not attend the meeting and this absence deepened R&AW's suspicions about America's true intent.

While India refused to sign the non-proliferation agreement because of the discriminatory nature of its provisions, it continued to play the leading role at multilateral disarmament forums, calling for the complete destruction of nuclear arsenal and a universal ban on nuclear testing. After the cold war ended, there was a perceptible shift in the stand of countries with nuclear weapons. Due to India's tough stand and leading role on the issue, the United Nations General Assembly in December 1993 adopted a resolution for the early conclusion of the Comprehensive Nuclear Test Ban Treaty (CTBT). Though India did not sign the treaty due to its discriminatory nature, it maintains even today that it is in favour of a world free of nuclear weapons, though in the presence of nuclear weapons elsewhere in the world, it needs to protect the country's interests first.